

When stress hits in the middle of the day

Seven steps. In order. About fifteen minutes.

1 Stop

Say it to yourself: **"Stop."** Don't react. Buy yourself thirty seconds.

2 Isolate

Five minutes alone. Bathroom, walk outside, your car.

3 Move IF YOU ONLY DO ONE - THIS ONE

Five minutes of real movement. Stairs. Push-ups. A brisk walk.

4 Breathe

Four cycles of 4-8 - if you've put in your daily sessions. Still early in the training? Give those minutes to movement instead.

5 No stimulants for the rest of the day

No extra coffee. No "one drink to take the edge off." **Tomorrow is fine. Today is not.**

6 Write it down, defer it

Into your **Worry Time notebook** - deal with it there, not now. And **don't retell the story today.**

7 Do something restorative

Somewhere green, a hot shower, **twenty minutes of music you love.**

The first reaction is almost always the wrong one. Follow the list. Don't invent.